

COMPARISON · MATRIX · STRUCTURE

matrix-grid

Two ordered axes as an $N \times M$ chart-family grid — each cell marks a position (filled / reachable / not applicable), colored by its row's category from the theme's chart palette.

Your level is a cell, not a rung.

Your title is the diagonal — the same verb at a wider reach is a different level.



● Your level . ○ where you can operate when called for – illustrative, placements vary by company.

Six categories by five columns is the grid's practical ceiling.

	SELF	PAIR	TEAM	ORG	FIELD
Vision					Chief
Strategy				VP	
Execution			Director		
Delivery		Manager			
Craft	Senior				
Basics	Associate				

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		WIDER REACH ►			
		SELF	TEAM	ORG	FIELD
DEEPER COGNITION ►	Create				Distinguished
	Evaluate			Principal	
	Analyze			Staff	
	Apply		Senior		
	Understand	Mid			
	Remember	Junior			

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When NOT to reach for matrix-grid.

Pass/fail or delivery status

If cells mean shipped/at-risk/blocked, use `obligation-matrix` or `roadmap` — their semantic state palette (pass/warn/fail) is built for exactly that read, and matrix-grid's categorical row colors would mislead.

More than one filled cell per row

Each row names one position — one `[x]`. Multiple filled cells in a row breaks the "this is where you are" read; use `[-]` for the cells the row can still reach.

Unordered axes

The grid earns its shape when both axes have a real order (shallow → deep, narrow → wide). Two free categorical labels belong in `matrix-2x2`.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`obligation-matrix` — rows × columns of pass/partial/exempt status,
not a single position

`roadmap` — phases × workstreams delivery status

`matrix-2x2` — two free axes, four cells, qualitative placement

`verdict-grid` — options scored against shared criteria, one card
per option